Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

925 sterling silver, resonant planar antenna, secure element
Foundation Edition · 10 individually numbered instruments worldwide

Software can propose, draft and calculate. Signet 01 is the physical instrument through which a person authorises what is carried out in their name.

The premise: verifiable human agency

Signet rings once gave physical decrees their authority through an unmistakable personal mark. Signet 01 brings that principle into digital life, where software and autonomous agents increasingly draft, simulate and carry out actions on our behalf.

The instrument binds a hardware-isolated signing key to a deliberate gesture of the hand. Touching the ring to a compatible phone turns intent into a signature that anyone can check against the exact words or request it covers.

Architecture and induction

The face carries an unbroken twelve-turn square spiral cut into the metal. It is both the visual seal and the working antenna.

The body is investment-cast in 925 sterling silver and finished by hand. The spiral draws energy from the phone's field at the moment of contact, powering the secure element without a battery. Between touches the instrument is entirely inert.

Cryptographic execution

The phone prepares the instruction as EIP-712 typed structured data. The ring's secure element signs its digest with ECDSA, using a private key generated on the chip that cannot be exported.

The resulting seal verifies against the ring's public key using open standards. Any change to the signed data after sealing causes verification to fail. What a seal authorises is set by the permissions of the system that receives it.

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Calibre specifications

Antenna	Integrated 12-turn planar square spiral · 13.56 MHz
Secure element	ARX HaLo · passive, powered during contact
Curve	ECDSA / secp256k1
Payload	EIP-712 typed structured data
Identity	LUKSO Universal Profile (ERC-725) · LSP6 Key Manager permissions
Power	None stored. No battery, no charging

Provenance and The Register

Signet 01 works with LUKSO Universal Profiles, where the ring's key can act as a physical controller with defined permissions. Those permissions can be granted, narrowed or revoked on-chain, so the owner's identity persists independently of any one piece of hardware.

The Register is designed to record each numbered piece: its casting, edition number and every authorised change of key.

Movement modularity and service life

Signet 01 is built around a serviceable calibre. The electronic assembly sits in an inner cavity designed for studio removal and renewal.

As hardware standards change over the decades, the calibre can be replaced while the hand-finished silver body and its edition number are kept. A new calibre carries a new signing key, and each authorised change is recorded in The Register.

Industrial design

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer whose work spans everyday objects, medical technology and digital instruments. He has practised in Milan, Amsterdam and London, including work with Stefano Giovannoni, Marcel Wanders and Tom Dixon, and is now based in Adelaide.

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